

Chhattri

छतरी · umbrella

Merchant insurance where the claim starts itself

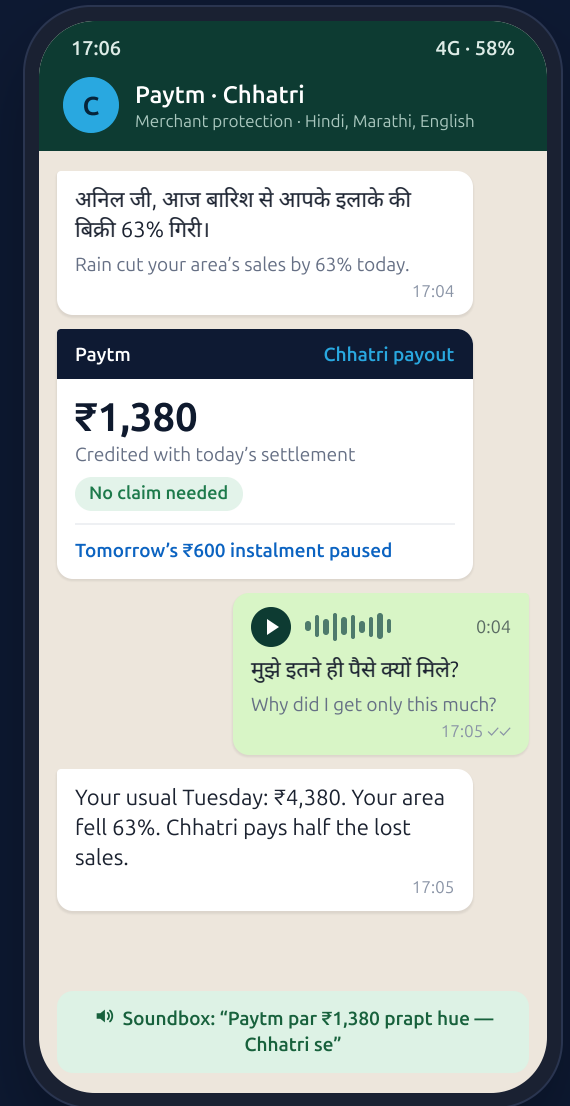
Paytm already sees when a shop's income stops. When rain or a heatwave hits an area, Chhattri pays every insured shop there automatically. When one shop goes quiet because its owner is ill, it reaches out first and settles with one photo. Money arrives the same day, and that day's loan instalment pauses.

TEAM

Da Goats

MEMBERS

Omkar Kadam · Ujjwal Pardeshi



PROBLEM STATEMENT

A bad day costs a shop its income. Getting paid for it takes weeks, if it happens at all

Time to money after a loss, in days



Chhatri

 Same day

Earlier plans also needed multiple documents, and outcomes were uncertain, so merchants stopped trusting the category.

Why merchant insurance keeps failing

What breaks	What the evidence says
Claims are slow and need proof	Paytm’s earlier merchant plans took 30 to 60 days and needed multiple documents
Weather readings miss real losses	Across 270 Indian weather-insurance contracts: a one-in-three chance of no payout even after a total crop loss
Loan instalments don’t stop	Daily instalments are cut from settlements, even on the day sales collapse

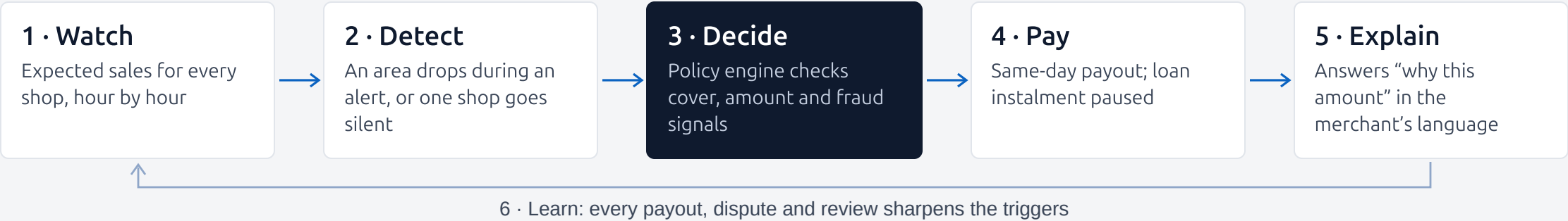
The fix is already inside Paytm: it sees every shop’s sales live, across **1.57 crore device merchants**. It can **measure the loss instead of guessing it**.

A rainy day today means weeks of paperwork. With Chhatri, it's paid that evening

TYPICAL TODAY	
Day 1	Heavy rain; sales fall 60%. The ₹600 loan instalment is still cut
Day 2	Anil searches for the policy and the claim form
Day 5	Uploads bills and photos; is asked for more
Day 30–60	Claim decided, if the loss is covered at all
Paid in 30–60 days Forms and documents · outcome uncertain	
WITH CHHATRI	
14:00	Red alert; the area's sales drop below the model's expected range
17:00	The drop holds for 3 hours across 46 shops; the trigger fires
17:04	₹1,380 credited with the settlement; the Soundbox announces it
17:05	Tomorrow's ₹600 instalment paused automatically
Paid the same day 0 forms · 0 documents	

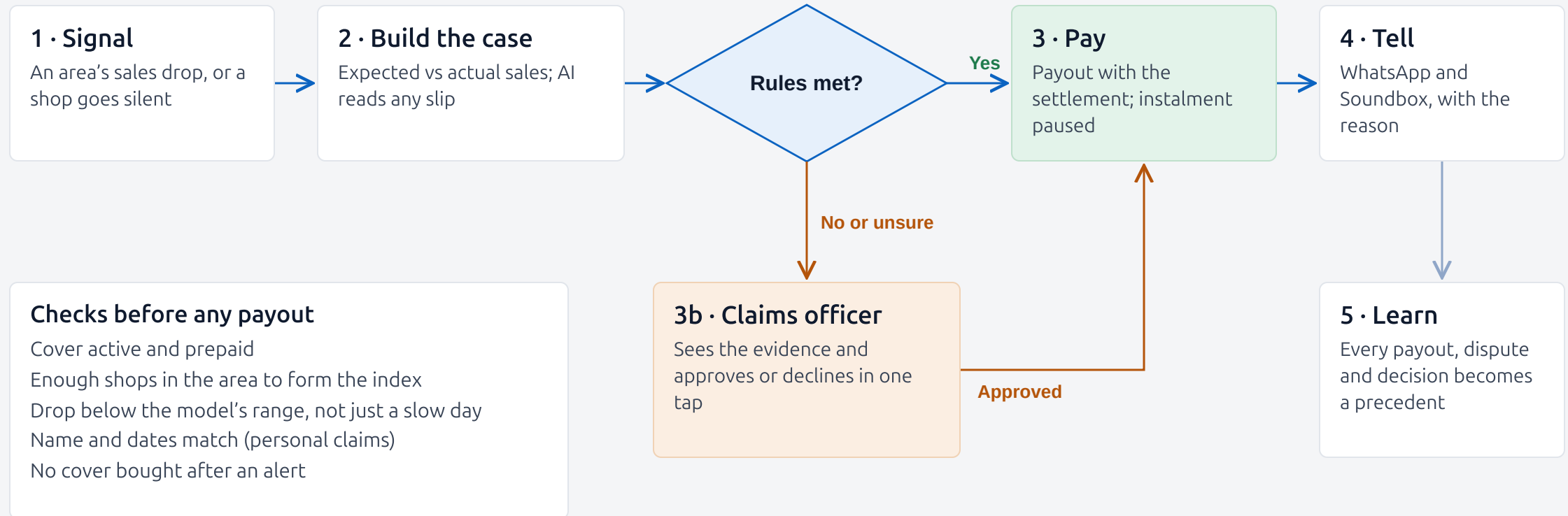
Paytm's merchant plan already fixed price and sign-up: under ₹2 a day, three taps in the app. Chhatri fixes the part that broke trust before: **the claim.**

One engine, two ways a claim starts itself



	Area shock · rain, heatwave, bandh	Personal shock · illness, accident
Starts when	A weather or civic alert, and the area’s sales fall far below expected	A shop’s payments stop for a full business day
Merchant does	Nothing	Replies to a voice check-in and sends one photo
Checked by	An area-level index, so one shop can’t fake it	AI reads the slip; name matches KYC; dates match the silent days
Paid	Same day, automatically	Same day; doubtful cases go to a human

Chhatri pays only what the policy and the data allow



The AI builds the case. **Code checks every payout against the policy** before any money moves, and every step is logged.

The claims team sees the loss as it happens



TRIGGERED Zone 7 · 46 shops	
Alert	Red alert from 14:00
Sales	41% of expected for 3 hours
Cover	46 of 46 prepaid
Paid	17:04, with the settlement
Total	₹58,900 · instalments paused

3
zones triggered

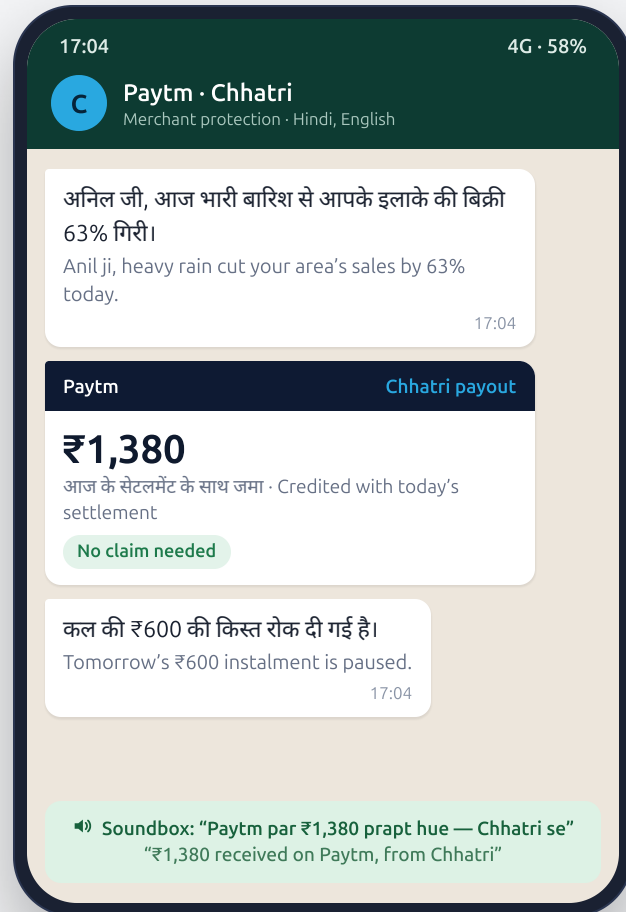
312
shops paid

4 min
trigger to money

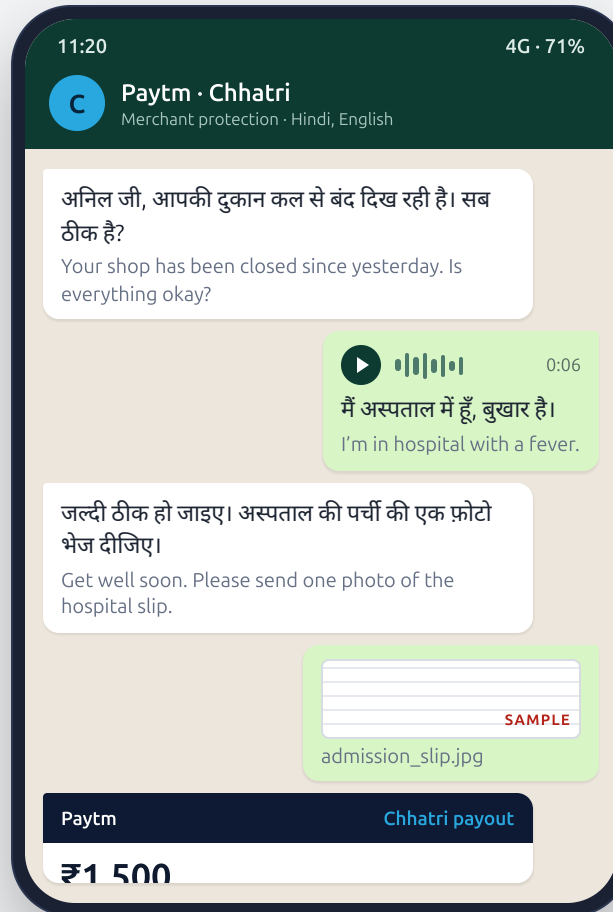
Why Zone 9 got nothing: its sales fell to 61% on a day with no weather alert. That's a slow day, not a loss event, so Chhatri doesn't pay.

The merchant gets it on WhatsApp, in Hindi and English

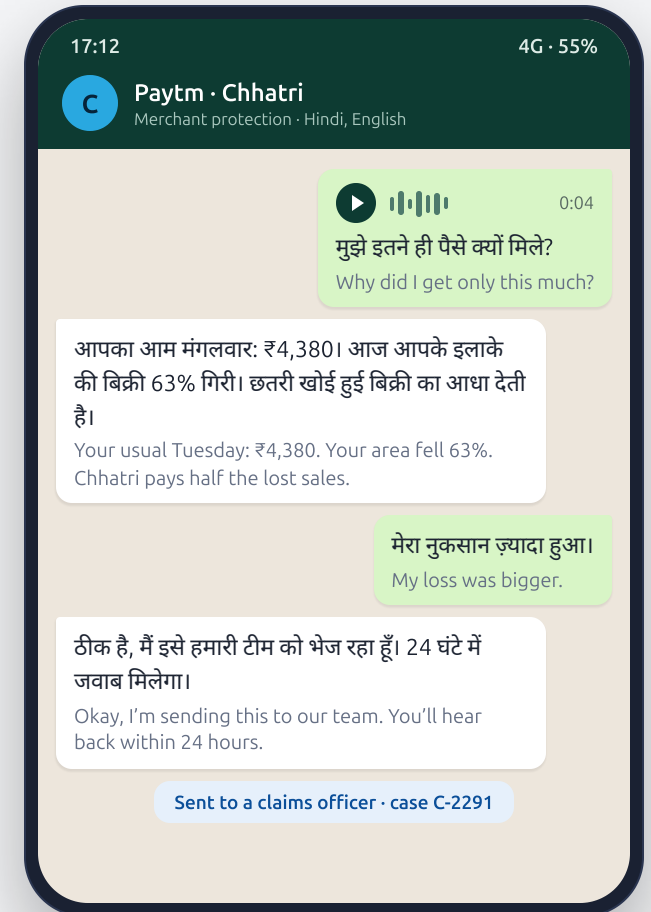
1 · RAIN DAY paid automatically



2 · ILLNESS one photo



3 · QUESTIONS answered with his numbers



Automatic when the data is clear, human when it isn't

Payout authority · starting rules for the pilot

Case	Chhatri alone	Goes to a human
Area drop during an alert, index clear	Pays	Only if the merchant disputes
Personal claim, slip matches name and dates	Pays up to the daily cap	Anything above the cap
Slip unclear or dates don't match	Never	Always
Cover bought after an alert	Never	Waiting period applies

New cover starts only after a **waiting period**, so nobody can buy it once a storm is forecast.

THREE LIVE TESTS IN OUR DEMO

“My loss was bigger than that.”

EXPLAINED Chhatri shows the numbers and offers a human review.

A hospital slip with a different name

HUMAN No automatic payout. A claims officer decides.

“Red alert tomorrow. Cover me today.”

BLOCKED New cover starts after the waiting period.

Statistics measure the loss, AI talks to people, code controls the money

SIGNALS

Hourly sales per shop

Weather and civic alerts

Merchant voice replies

Photos of hospital slips

Loan instalment schedule

REASONING + MEMORY

Expected-sales model

LightGBM per area and shop type. Pays only when sales fall below the bottom of its prediction range.

Sarvam chat + vision model

Sarvam runs the conversation in the merchant's language; a vision model reads the slip.

Cognee memory graph

Links shops, areas, past events, payouts and disputes.

CONTROL

Policy engine

FastAPI service with cover rules, caps and the waiting period

Checks prepaid cover, the area index, KYC and dates

The only layer that can approve a payout

Writes the audit log

ACTION

n8n workflows

Payout, instalment pause, human review and follow-ups

Paytm payment links

Premium paid through the Paytm MCP server (staging)

Sarvam voice

Bulbul speaks on WhatsApp and the Soundbox; Saaras hears code-mixed Hindi

STACK

Python + FastAPI

LightGBM

Sarvam: Bulbul, Saaras, chat

Cognee

n8n

Paytm MCP server

WhatsApp Cloud API

Open-Meteo

React + Leaflet

What Chhatri adds to merchant insurance

	Traditional merchant claim	Weather-only cover	Chhatri
What starts the claim	The merchant files it	A weather reading	The shop's own sales data
Proof needed	Bills, photos and forms	None	None for area events; one photo for personal ones
Matches the real loss	Assessed case by case	Often not: a one-in-three chance of missing a total loss in one study	Measured from actual sales
Time to money	30–60 days (Paytm's earlier plans)	6–8 weeks (SEWA heat cover)	Same day
Loan instalment on a bad day	Still due	Still due	Paused automatically
Hard to game	Documents can be faked	Yes	Area-level trigger, KYC and date checks, waiting period

Chhatri doesn't replace Paytm's merchant plan. It gives it **claims that start themselves**.

Impact we will measure: backtest first, then one monsoon pilot

One flood-prone city · merchants already on Paytm's plan vs a control group

Measure	Target
Real sales drops that get paid (backtest)	More than a weather-only trigger
Payouts with no real drop	Fewer than a weather-only trigger
Trigger to money	Same day
Documents per area claim	Zero
Doubtful personal claims seen by a human	All of them
Premiums vs payouts, per area	Within the insurer's target

The backtest replays two past monsoons on sandboxed sales data before any live payout.

Who benefits

Merchants

Money on the day they lose it, no forms, and no instalment squeeze

Insurer

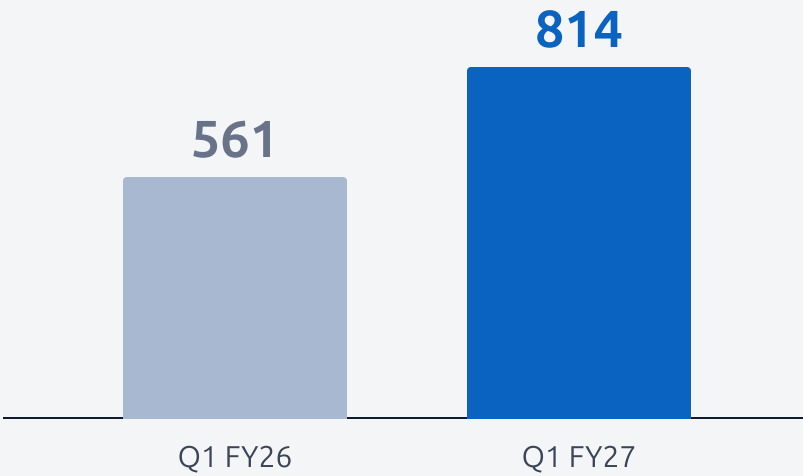
Losses measured, not guessed, and far cheaper claims to run

Paytm

More merchants who renew, more insurance revenue, fewer missed instalments

Chhatri grows insurance revenue and protects the loan book

Paytm financial services revenue, ₹ crore



+45% in a year. Insurance sits in this line, and it grows on merchants who stay active on Paytm.

How it's priced: a few rupees a day, set per area from its history. Each evening's settlement prepays the next day's cover, because insurers can't take on risk before the premium is paid (Insurance Act, Sec. 64VB).

Where the value comes from

Value driver	How Chhatri moves it
Insurance distribution	A rider on the existing merchant plan, sold in the same three taps
Merchant renewals	Getting paid on a bad day is the best reason to renew
Loan quality	On bad days, instalments are paused and covered instead of missed
Data for Pi	A live area income index, offered to insurers and lenders

GO-TO-MARKET

Start as a rider on Paytm's merchant plan (2 lakh+ merchants) in one flood-prone city, with one insurer. Add heatwave cover for north India. Later, offer the area income index to insurers and lenders through Pi.

A working prototype by 3 October, then a monsoon pilot

By 3 October

Hackathon final

Storm replay on a live city heat map

Personal claim on WhatsApp in Hindi: voice and one photo

Payout, instalment pause and audit log

Premium paid with a real Paytm link (staging)

Before the next monsoon

Backtest and pilot

Replay two past monsoons on sandboxed sales data

Set triggers and prices with one insurer

Pilot with merchants already on the plan, in one city

After the pilot

Scale

Heatwave and bandh cover

More cities and languages

Area income index for insurers through Pi

What is live in our prototype: Sarvam voice, the policy engine, WhatsApp, the claims console and the Paytm premium link (staging, through the Paytm MCP server). Sales data, the weather replay, KYC, payouts and the lender are simulated and labelled.

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Full-stack engineer

Ujjwal Pardeshi

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